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Armed citizen pulls gun on Oregon mall shooter

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Nick Meli recounts how he pulled his gun and took aim at the mall shooter

A Portland, Oregon man is recounting the terror he encountered inside a shopping mall when a gunman opened fire killing

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The man had a gun of his own and had to make a split second decision as he came face to face with the gunman.

Nick Meli is emotionally drained. The 22-year-old was at Clackamas Town Center with a friend and her 4-month-old baby when a masked gunman opened fire.

"I heard three shots and I turned and looked at Casey and I go , are you ***** serious? She looks at me and she goes 'yeah,'" Meli said.

As the friend and baby hit the floor, Meli, who has a concealed carry permit, positioned himself behind a pillar.

"He was working on his rifle, he kept pulling the charging handle and hitting the side," he said.

The break in gunfire allowed Meli to pull out his own gun, a glock 22, but he never took his eyes off the shooter.

"In my mind I kept saying like drop it.. drop the gun, you know, and when I drew up I got tunnel vision and all I saw was my front sight on his head and I was indexing and as I was going down I was going to pull, I saw someone in the back of the Charlotte move, and I knew that if I fired and missed, I could end up hitting them," he said.

So, Meli took cover inside a nearby store. he never did pull the trigger and he stands by that decision.

"I'm not beating myself up because I didn't shoot him, but I know after he saw me, I think the last shot he fired was the one he used on himself."

The gunman was dead, but not before taking two innocent lives with him and as Meli points out taking the innocence of everyone else.

"I don't ever want to have to see anyone that way ever, it bothers me," he said.

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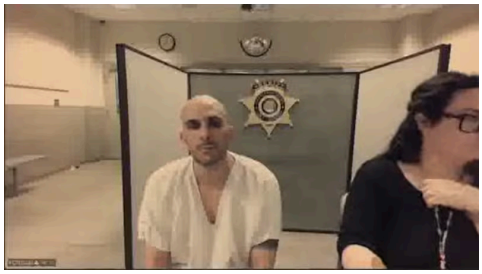
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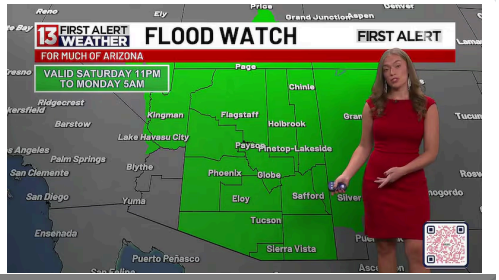
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